

A Hero and a Great Man

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by Francis Kruchvich

Illustrations by

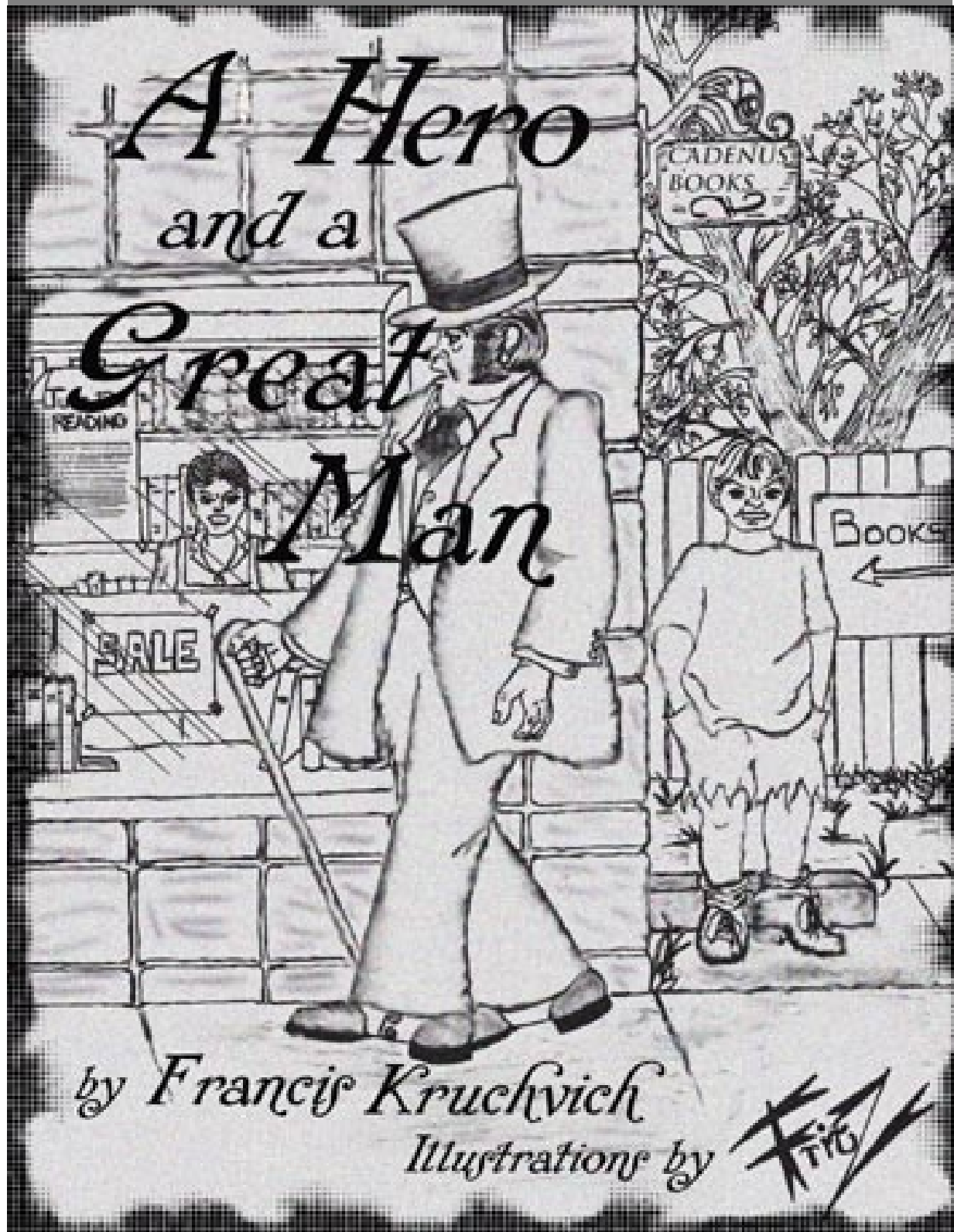
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Frigo



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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A HERO AND A
GREAT MAN ***



A Hero and a Great Man

Story by
Francis Kruckvich

Illustrations by
Fritz

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A Hero and A Great Man



We hang the petty thieves and appoint
the great ones to public office
- Aesop

They say knowledge is
power.
Power walks with ambition.
Ambition will devour
A man without vision.

Through a turbid town,
A great man walks.
Through a troubled town,
A great man talks.

He tells tales of bravery.
On attention he feeds.
With speech most savory
He boasts of great deeds.

He is well respected.
He enjoys much recognition.
He hopes to be selected
For a prestigious position.

He likes to be seen.
He likes to be heard.
When he is on the scene,
He fills the air with word.



As greatness is a need
This need is his fate.
He is as great indeed,
As his need to feel great.

One day as he was walking,
He happened to overhear
Two girls that were talking.
He turned his curious ear.

As their words he overheard,
He felt his aid was required.
Always attracted to the
spoken word
To the girls he inquired,

“Why do you girls carry on
In such a vociferous way?
To you my attention is drawn
Upon this beautiful day!!!”

And to him the him girls
inquired,
“Where does the sun go at
night?”
He knew an answer was
required.
But he knew not what was
right.

Where it goes, he could not
say
As he covertly looked about.
Being a master of delay,
He calmly searched for an
out.

A man was passing by
And overheard this
conversation.
He thought he could supply,
A goodly explanation.



Details of this man are
unknown
For he lived a life withdrawn.
He prefers to be quiet and
alone.
A common life he has
forgone.

You see, he was not like you
and me.
His methods were strange
and new.
A different world his eyes
would see.
A world in which others
would have no clue.

Despite his odd looks.
He is more than he appears.
He has read many books,
Yet still wet behind the ears.

Every culture to its own will
conform.
The mind of the crowd is a
shallow creek.
As this man was far from the
norm,
He was seen by the people as
a freak.

He values his peace.
He is devoted to thought.
This is his release.
Nothing finer could be
bought.

As peace is a need
This need is his fate.
Attempting to run from
greed,
On simplicity he would
concentrate.

He never felt the peace
That he needed to feel.
He would never cease
To search for what's real.



If work was completed
According to plan,
It should not be repeated
By a frustrated man.

The only exception
For such repetition
Is the struggle for perfection,
Or the folly of a politician.

When he did a deed,
When he found satisfaction,
He could see no need
For any further action.

If nothing was there broken
Or no deed to be done,
No answer to be spoken,
Then action was there none.

If there is no disruption
And everything seems in
balance,
Wasteful action is corruption
Of the purest talents.

A problem of complexity
Needs a simple solution.
A mind in perplexity
Is lost in convolution.

Now for the girls' question,
He felt he knew, really.
He had a suggestion,
And he offered it freely.



“A weary sun will hide
To give a new night birth.
The sun then goes to the
other side
Of our blessed Mother
Earth.”

The problem seemed to be
solved.

The great man saw this.
He went to get involved.
For attention he could not
miss.

The freak's words had merit.
An advantage had been
gained,
But the great man could not
bear it.
His status must be
maintained.

The freak's words he twisted
With his eloquent speech.
His charisma could not be
resisted.
It was he who would teach.

He took the freak's idea
And made it his own.
No man would be right
Except he alone.

He devised his own story
Using the freak's word.
He would take the glory
And make the freak seem
absurd.

“He is not entirely correct.”
The great man thus began.
“I mean no disrespect
But I am, of course, a great
man!”

“He was on the right track.
This I won’t deny.
What truth may he lack,
I will attempt to supply.



He does not know, it seems,
That our grateful relation
To the Sun’s warm beams
Lies in the Earth’s rotation.

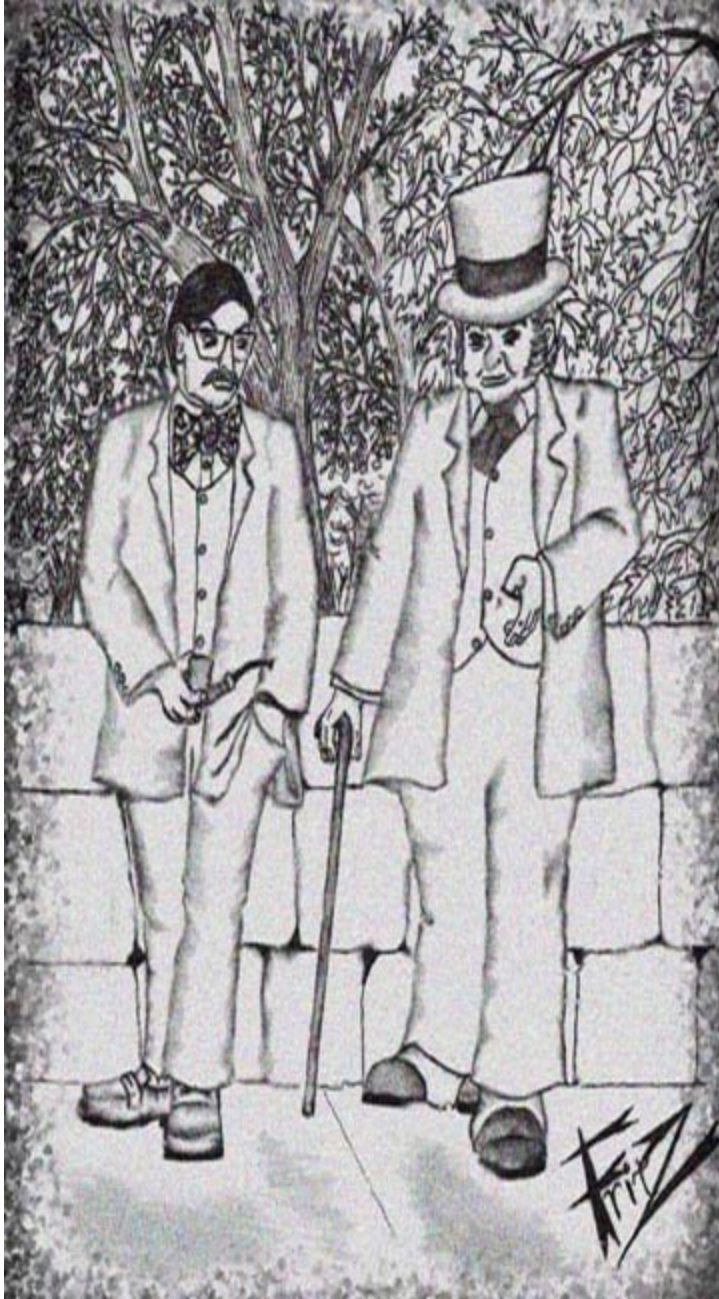
If you but wait,
This problem I will solve.
Upon its axis straight,
Does the Earth revolve.

As our great God
Is wont to create,
Upon this imaginary rod
Does the Earth rotate.

The sun remains still
While the Earth moves and
spins
Where the sun’s warmth may fill
A new day on Earth begins.

Just as the moon is the reason
For waves in the ocean
The change of the season
Is the Earth in Her motion.

It is basic science.
The sun could never hide.
Our Earth is in complete
reliance
Of the Sun on every side.”



The girls were amazed
At this great display of
speech.
Into the great man's eyes they
gazed
As he proceeded to teach.

A lesson he had taught
Not unlike a story compiled
From a borrowed thought
With it's author left reviled.

The freak was appalled
Watching innocence
beguiled.
The girls were enthralled
While the great man smiled.

Who was being deceived?
The freak felt some dismay.
The great man the girls
believed.
And the freak just walked
away.

It seemed childish to contest.
He saw no reason to fight.
He thought best not to
protest.
Both of their answers were
right.

Over time the great man grew
To earn a great man's
reputation.
His words would cause much
ado
And even some speculation.

A few weeks quickly went by
During which time came a
threat.

No rain had fallen from the
sky,
But the ground seemed to be
wet.



Water trickled like blood
from a gash.
Soon the streets turned to
mud.
People could not walk
without a splash.
There was fear that the town
would flood.

Slowly, this problem would
develop.
The water would continue to
run.
Eventually, the whole town it
would envelop
If something was not soon
done.

Water does not feel sorrow
nor care
Wherever it trickles and
roams.
The people were becoming
more aware,
For it was soon in their
homes.

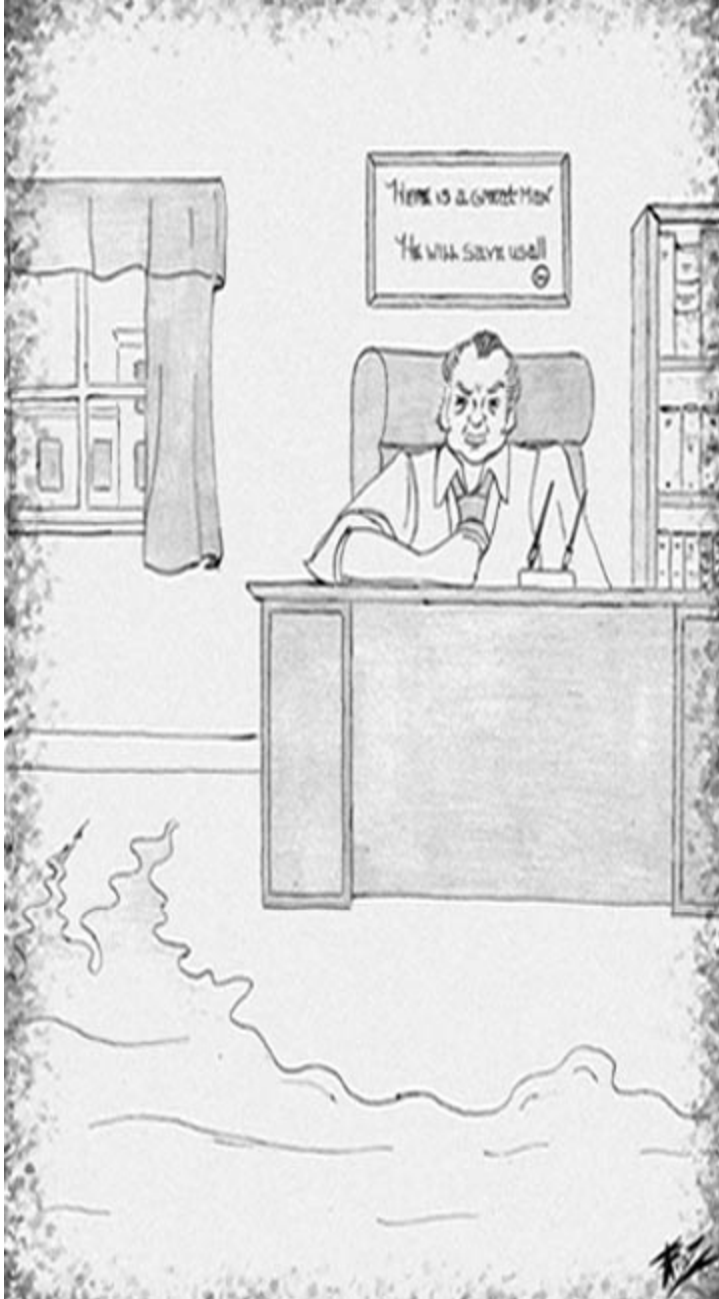
To the great man the people
went
For some kind of solution.
There must be a way to
prevent
Any further ground dilution.

The great man promised thus,
“To you I can assure,
For any problem threatening

us
For sure there is a cure!”

“I will stop this silly little
flood.
Upon the great man you can
rely.
The ground may be covered
in mud
But, somewhere, must a
solution lie!”

In his office the great man sat
Staring at the water on the
floor.
He knew not how to deal
with that,
But he knew there would be
more.



Desperately trying to think of
a plan

He repeatedly read the plaque
on the wall,

“Here is a Great Man
He will save us all!”

The sparkling water had a
sense of beauty
As it reflected in the plaque.
A painful reminder of his
duty,
A leader must never slack.

So, eagerly, he donned his
heavy boots,
And ventured forth for a walk
Through a series of muddy
routes,
For to the people he must
talk.

The great man noticed one
man solitary
As he trekked a turbid trail.
To the woods with buckets he
did carry
In a struggling effort his
home to bail.

Though his face he could not
see,
He knew that this man to be
clever and brave.
He could not dwell on who it
could be

For the great man had a town
to save.

He thought of the people as
his duty required
To give them this instruction.
By this sight he was inspired
To save the town from
destruction.

“Together we must pull!
This I must accent!”
So each man scooped a
bucket full
And into the woods with the
water they went.



Soon this method had no effect.
The water continued to rise.
The people were beginning to suspect,
This is not where the solution lies.

The great man saw this method would fail
But he knew he must not quit.
Again he trekked the turbid trail
To this problem he did commit.

Then the great man saw a lone man dig
A trench in which the water would drop.
He dug it deep and he dug it big.
Perhaps, in this trench, the water would stop!

He thought of the people, as his duty required
To give them this instruction.
By this site he was again inspired
To save the town from destruction.

“We must dig a great ditch
In which the water will drop.
Into this we all must pitch
If the water we are to stop!

A solution to this we must
seek.
Look to me in your time of
need.
Though the situation may
now look bleak,
We will succeed with my
lead!”

Upon his shoulder, he felt a
hand.
It was, in fact, the odd man.
The great man, at first, did
not understand.
Then the freak thus began,



“You may be great and the
people strong,
But this won’t stop the
water’s force.
This will not work for very
long.
We must stop it at the
source.”

The great man let out a great
big laugh,
And to the odd man he talked
down.

“You think you can speak on
the people’s behalf?
A great man must save this
town!”

“We all share the same
concern.
Your offer I do appreciate,
However, to experience, we
must now turn.
This issue is too great.”

As the great man continued to
give his speech
The freak had turned and
walked away.

A solution soon someone
must reach
No matter what the great man
would say.

Soon the town will certainly
be
Just a huge pool of mud.
It is not really hard to see

That nothing is stopping this
great flood.

His mind was cloudy and his
feet were muddy.

While the great man talked
and talked,

The freak used this time to
think and study,

So in search of the source he
walked.

The freak followed the water
alone.

Deep into the woods he was
led.

There he found a slab of
stone.

On the stone it read,



“In the event of a flood
This lesson should be learned
Unless you like to live in
mud,
The valve must be turned.”

Below these words there was
an arrow
And it was pointing to the
creek.

The creek had begun to
overflow.

This was, no doubt, the
source of the leak.

The freak was indeed happy
to learn

How the flood had been
produced.

He found the valve and gave
it a turn.

And the water immediately
was reduced.

He went back up the muddy
trail

And told the people what he
had done.

But no one would believe his
tale,

Not a single, solitary one.

Afraid of being deceived,
The people showed only
doubt,

“Why should he be believed?
What is he all about?”

Skepticism and emotion
Were sparked by the freak's
word.

His story caused quite a
commotion,
And the great man, of course,
overheard.

He said, "I will solve this
dispute.

Whatever the problem, there
must be a plan.

Of the truth, we are in
pursuit.

A great problem requires a
great man!"



“I’d like a word, please come with me,”

To the freak the great man said.

The freak complied with his plea.

To the great man’s office he was led.

Once in his office, he closed the door.

He could not wait to ask,
“What did you do, I want to hear more,
About how you pursued this task.”

As the freak began to describe
The valve at the creek and slab of stone.
The great man was not willing to subscribe
To this story by a man who lives alone.

The great man was in disbelief.

He began to give the freak a speech.

His talk was not short, nor was it brief.

To the freak, a lesson he would teach.

He told the freak about being great,

And that by his word he
would rule.
Being a master at debate,
He made the freak look like a
fool.

From the office the freak
went,
Stuck on the words the great
man had said.
He walked the path back
home in resent,
As the great man's voice he
heard in his head.

It's obvious that the town is
his.
He could hear the people as
he walked through.
"Who in the world does he
think he is?
He thinks he is a great man
too!"



The farther he walked the
angrier he became,
To think that words could
outshine skill.

“Great man, bah...what a
name!
I’ll show them all, I will!”

Into the forest, he marched in
retaliation.

He felt the need to settle the
score.

He could not bear this
indignation.

This town was not his home
anymore.

He found again the slab of
stone.

He found again the valve by
the creek.

Never before had he felt so
alone.

Revenge now did he seek.

In his anger, he turned the
valve back.

The water began to overflow.
He thought, for a moment,
about this attack.

Then he decided the people
must know.

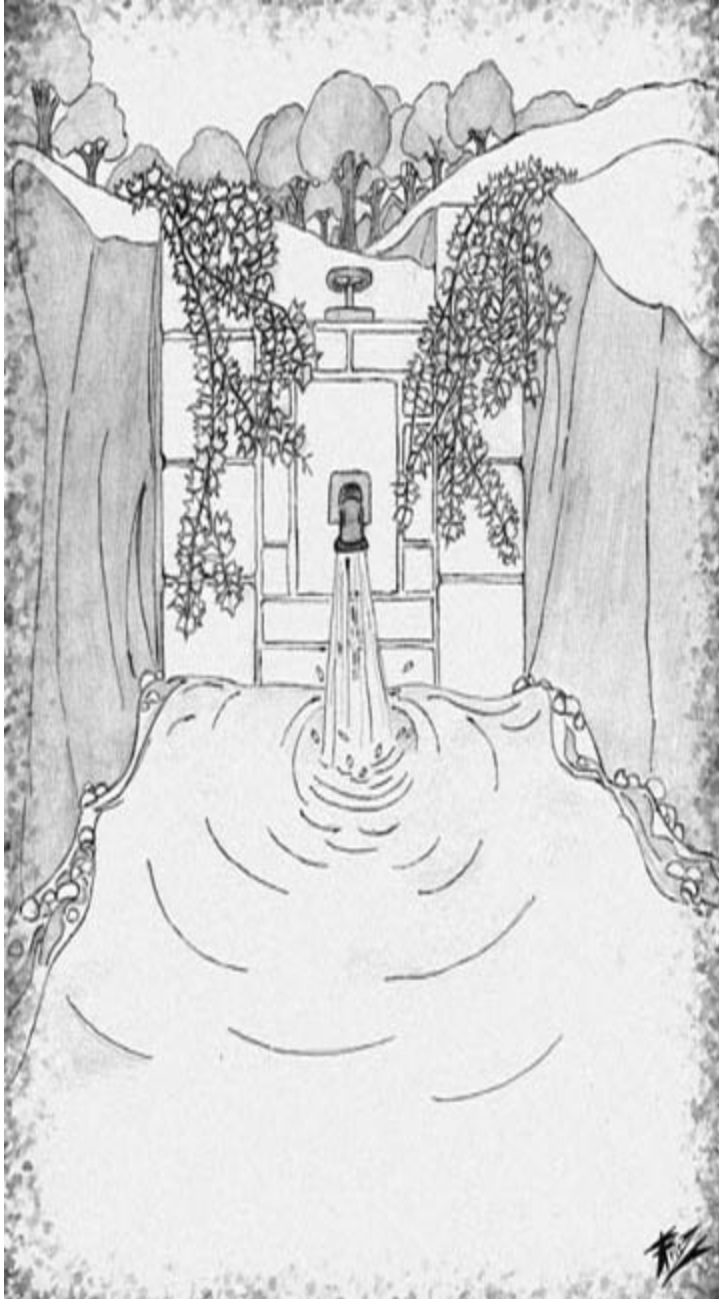
On the way back, he felt
some guilt.

His conscience was big and
his mind was young.

Upon action his existence
was built.
Once back in town, he held
his tongue.

The town again began to
flood.
And the people again began
to worry.
The ground again had turned
to mud.
To their buckets again the
people would hurry.

The efforts again the great
man would direct,
But an effort repeated is a
lesson taught.
Soon the bucket method had
no effect,
And this sent the great man
into thought.



The man with the bucket, he
only saw from afar.
And the man in the trench,
never showed his face.
He began to feel that this was
bizarre,
And then this pattern, he
began to trace.

These men were indeed one
and the same!
The great man was struck
with revelation.
This peculiar freak, with no
name,
Had been the source of his
inspiration!

He headed down the muddy
trail,
Into the forest he would
withdraw.
There he dropped his water
pale.
He could not believe what he
saw.

There he found a slab of
stone
Just as the freak had said.
He wondered how this could
go unknown
As the words on the stone he
read,

“In the event of a flood
This lesson should be learned

Unless you like to live in
mud,
The valve must be turned.”

Below these words there was
an arrow
And it was pointing to the
creek.
The creek had begun to
overflow.
No doubt this was the source
of the leak.

The great man was indeed
happy to learn
How the flood had been
produced.
He found the valve and gave
it a turn.
And the water immediately
was reduced.



He went back up the muddy trail,

And told the people what he had done.

The people all gathered to hear his tale,

And all were intrigued, but one.

“Knowledge is power,” the great man began.

“A man who knows power is a man who is wise.

The greater the problem, the greater the man

Who can find the answer that’s little in size.

Great men do heroic deeds.
Over the common men they tower.

Great men are what this town needs...

Men who face danger, and do not cower.

I am a great man, but a hero am I?

That’s a title I cannot claim.

There are those whose talent we may deny,

But they are heroes just the same.”

As they heard those words so profound,

The people hailed the great

man and cheered.
The freak looked down at the
ground.
He knew to them he would
always seem weird.

The girls who argued about
the sun walked by.
They offered him words so
sweet,
“You’re a nice man, there’s
no need to cry.
He’s a great man, and he
can’t be beat.”

The freak looked at the girls
and smiled.
He could see that a leader is
all they need.
It’s noble to protect the
innocence of a child.
“Yes,” he said, “He is a great
man indeed.”

The End

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A HERO AND A
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